

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 10 6 4
 ♥ J 8 2
 ♦ K 8 4
 ♣ Q 8 3

♠ 8 3

♥ 7 5

♦ A Q 10 6 2

♣ A K 7 4



♠ J 9 7

♥ Q 10 9 6

♦ J 9

♣ J 10 6 2

♠ A K 5 2

♥ A K 4 3

♦ 7 5 3

♣ 9 5

West	North	East	South
	1♦	Pass	1♥
Pass	2♣	Pass	3NT
All Pass			
3NT by South			

South is to play 3NT. West leads the ♠4.

Winners: ♠=2 ♥=2 ♦=1 ♣=2 Total = 7

You need two more winners. They cannot possibly come from ♠s, ♥s, or ♣s since one defender must hold at least 4 cards in each of those suits. So your two extra winners must come from the ♦ suit.

There is no reason to hold up on the ♠ since the ♥ and ♣ suits also have just two stoppers. You win the ♠A.

Your best play next is to finesse the ♦10. This may gain a trick by virtue of the finesse if West happens to hold the ♦J, but primarily you are working to establish the ♦ suit. Assume East wins the ♦J and returns a ♠.

Again don't hold up. Take the ♠K and lead another small ♦, finessing with dummy's ♦Q. Happily this time the finesse works, and even more happily both defenders follow suit. That means the rest of the ♦s are good and you make an overtrick.

This was just a normal suit-establishment Deal.

If looked different because of the two finesses you took.

Board 2

North Deals

None Vul

♠ J 10 6 4 2

♥ K J 8

♦ 10 7 3

♣ K 2

♠ 9 7

♥ 4 3

♦ 8 6 5 2

♣ A 8 6 5 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A 8 5

♥ Q 10 9 6

♦ Q J 9

♣ 10 7 4

♠ K Q 3

♥ A 7 5 2

♦ A K 4

♣ Q J 9

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
	Pass	Pass	1 ♣
Pass	2 ♣	Pass	3NT
All Pass			
3NT by South			

South is to play 3NT. West leads the ♠4. East puts on the ♠A and returns the ♠8.

Winners: ♠=2 ♥=1 ♦=2 ♣=1 Total = 6

Needing three more winners you are going to have to establish the ♣ suit. You are also going to have to be lucky!

You win the second ♠ and play your ♣Q. West covers with the ♣K. What do you do next?

You **DUCK**. If you take the ♣A now you will never get back to dummy to enjoy those other ♣s. So let West have the ♣K. You win his return, (probably a ♠), and play ♣J, then ♣9 to dummy's ♣A. As long as ♣s split 3-2 you will get the three winners you need.

You were prepared to lose that ♣ finesse to East so you could establish the suit in dummy.

West's play of the ♣K may have made you want to jump up with the ♣A, but you must stick to the original play of ducking one trick.

Board 3

North Deals

None Vul

♠ K 10 8 2
 ♥ K 10 4
 ♦ 8 7 2
 ♣ K J 7

♠ 7 5 4
 ♥ A Q 8 7 5
 ♦ 9 6 3
 ♣ 8 4



♠ J 9 6
 ♥ J 9 2
 ♦ Q J 10
 ♣ 10 9 3 2

♠ A Q 3
 ♥ 6 3
 ♦ A K 5 4
 ♣ A Q 6 5

West	North	East	South
	Pass	Pass	1 ♦
Pass	1 ♥	Pass	2NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
3NT by South			

South is to play 3NT. West leads the ♠ 2. East puts on the ♠ J.

Winners: ♠=2 ♥=1 ♦=2 ♣=1 Total = 6

You need three more winners. It is possible your fourth ♦ can be established, but that needs a 3-3 split. It's also possible that the ♣ finesse will work, and also the ♥ finesse. Since you need the ♥ finesse anyway you should go ahead and try to establish the ♥s.

Win the first trick with your ♠Q and play a low ♥, ducking in dummy. East will no doubt win a cheap trick but no matter. When you next gain the lead play your other low ♥ and finesse the ♥Q. Assume this wins (if it doesn't you will be going down for sure). Play the ♥A and if both defenders follow your other 2 ♥s are good and your contract is made.

Ducking the first ♥ and finessing the second could let you wind up with no tricks at all in the ♥ suit.

But, it is your only chance to make the contract.

Board 4

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K Q J 10

♥ 10 9

♦ 7 4 3

♣ K 10 7 2

♠ 8 6 5 3

♥ K 5 4

♦ K J 10 8 5

♣ Q



♠ A 9 2

♥ J 7 3

♦ A 9 2

♣ J 9 6 5

♠ 7 4

♥ A Q 8 6 2

♦ Q 6

♣ A 8 4 3

West

North

East

South

Pass

3♥

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by South
dummy's ♥K.

Some pretty aggressive bidding gets you to a challenging game. South is to play 4♥. West leads the ♠K, overtaken by East's ♠A. East returns a ♠ to West's ♠10, and he then plays the ♠Q.

Losers: ♠=2 ♥=0 ♦=1 ♣=3 Total = 6

With 2 tricks already gone you still have 4 losers. You could consider ruffing the 3 ♣ losers in dummy but that would just create a trump loser even when trumps are splitting 3-2. So it looks like you will have to establish the ♦ suit for discards. You could pull trumps and then play your ♦Q, hoping the defenders will grab their ♦A immediately. But unless they are real novices they will hold it up one round and you'll no longer be able to reach dummy.

The solution is to establish the ♦s before you use up

Ruff the third ♠, then play ♦Q, (which they will duck), and another ♦, (which they will probably take). Win whatever they return, pull trumps ending in dummy, and enjoy your 3 ♦ winners.

If East does not take the second ♦ you continue the suit, and whether you ruff or discard a loser you still make the contract.